8.15 Principles for Cutting

The main role of a cutting department is to cut garment components from fabric rolls or fabric as per style specifications. Then the cut components are goes to sewing department in bundles. A cutting department of a garment manufacturing unit includes following sub-processes.

- Fabric relaxation. Fabric spreading / layering on cutting table
- Marker making
- Cutting - manual cutting (using scissors), machine cutting and automatic cutting
- Numbering of garment plies (parts). Shorting and Bundling
- Inspection of cut components
- Shorting of printed and embroidery panels
- Re-cutting of panels. Fusing garment components

8.15.1 Factors to be Considered While Cutting Special Fabrics

- Precision in cut i.e. the dimension of pattern and fabric parts cut should be same
- The cut edge must be cleaned
- Infused edge
- Consistency in fabric cutting
- Support of lay
- Place the fabrics on the cutting surface. This can be a large flat table or counter
- Should position the pattern pieces on the fold or on the grain line as indicated
- Every pattern pieces have a front side i.e. printed side and back side
- If the fabric has a one-way design then lay all the pattern pieces in the same direction with finished project in mind
- Accurate notch size. If it is large in size, it can be seen after sewing of fabrics. Also there is a great probability of producing problems in matching of patterns after sewing
- Drill hole and size should be appropriate and it will be placed in its right place. If it is too large it would be seen after sewing. But if it is too small then it can be blocked easily

Cutting Specific Type of Fabric

- Cut faux fur from the back
- Use a rotary cutter to cut leather
- Dampen slippery fabrics before cutting them
- Place tissue behind delicate fabric, but aware that it can dull the scissors
- Take care to align prints, plaids and stripes when cutting patterns

8.16 Preserving the Patterns Before Sewing

The sewing pattern or the one that can be used commonly should be preserved. A favourite sewing pattern should be preserved so that it can be used over and over again without becoming distorted or ripped. Patterns can be expensive, and many become unavailable so preserving the pattern will be helpful. Preserve the patterns so that it can be used for a years.

Steps to Preserve a Sewing Pattern

- Press the pattern pieces so that there are no wrinkles in the pattern. It needs to be smooth so that the final piece will be as accurate as the original pattern.

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